

Mel Rowlands

Product Designer · Edtech & Consumer Products

End-to-end product design across web and mobile. 20+ years across UX, brand, and platform — fluent with AI tooling.

Cape Town · Working remotely (US time zones)

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PROFILE

Product designer with deep experience designing **end-to-end consumer product experiences** for web and mobile — wireframes, user flows, prototypes, and high-fidelity interfaces. Co-founded and shipped a full-stack **edtech platform for children**, owning onboarding, subscription flows, content discovery, and design system from concept to launch. Comfortable working cross-functionally with product, engineering, and data partners in fast-moving environments. **AI-augmented design practice** using Figma AI, Claude, and Claude Code in daily client work.

HIGHLIGHTS

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|---------------------------------|---|
| Co-founded & shipped | iNGENiO Education — full-stack edtech platform for children's digital art learning. |
| Licensed | Surface pattern collections to Studio E Fabrics and Nested Bean (USA). |
| Co-founded | Fineday Design Studio — 7 years building brands for Yuppiechef, Sarah Graham, Shackleton. |
| Started at | Goldman Sachs (London), Investment Research division — 7 years as a Junior Analyst. |

EXPERIENCE

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| Co-founder & Lead Designer
<i>iNGENiO Education · Cape Town · Remote</i> | 2023 — Present |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">Designed and shipped end-to-end edtech platform for children aged 5–18 — onboarding, course discovery, subscription flows, progress tracking.Built and evolved a design system for consistency and scalability across web and mobile.Improved user engagement and time-on-platform through iterative design and qualitative feedback from families and educators.Own product design end-to-end — UX, AI, visual design, brand, and platform implementation (WordPress, WooCommerce, LearnDash). | |
| Contract Designer
<i>Dataloop · Hybrid</i> | 2022 — 2023 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">Contracted across dashboards, internal tools, and design — practical grounding in data-led design.Designed wireframes, user flows, and high-fidelity interfaces for technical users.Translated complex workflows into clear, intuitive experiences — simplifying multi-step processes for non-expert users. | |
| Co-owner & Designer
<i>Fineday Design Studio · Cape Town</i> | 2015 — 2022 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">Co-led design studio for 7 years — brand systems, packaging, and consumer product design for Yuppiechef, Sarah Graham, Jimmy Public, Shackleton.Licensed two international surface pattern ranges (Studio E Fabrics, Nested Bean USA) — products sold across US retail. | |
| Freelance Graphic Designer
<i>Independent · Cape Town</i> | 2007 — 2015 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">Eight years of independent design across branding, print, and visual identity — the grounding that became Fineday. | |
| Junior Analyst, Investment Research
<i>Goldman Sachs · London</i> | 2000 — 2007 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">Seven years in Investment Research — research, analysis, and high-stakes work for institutional clients. The grounding still shapes how I approach every project. | |

CAPABILITIES

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| Product Design · End-to-end UX, user flows, wireframes, prototypes, hi-fi interfaces (web + mobile). | Design Systems · Building and evolving scalable component libraries. |
| Consumer Products · Onboarding, content discovery, subscription flows, engagement, retention. | User Research · Qualitative feedback, usability iteration, data-led design decisions. |
| AI Tooling · Figma AI, Claude, Claude Code, agentic workflows in real client work. | Tools · Figma, Adobe Creative Suite, WordPress, LearnDash, WooCommerce, HTML/CSS. |

SELECTED WORK

- iNGENiO Education** — Edtech platform for children. End-to-end product design: onboarding, discovery, subscription, design system.
- The Huddle App** — Mobile app designed and shipped end-to-end, concept through deployment.
- Pattern Licensing** — International product partnerships with Studio E Fabrics and Nested Bean (USA).